Alphabetical Order

Year 4 · Supplementary Worksheet — extra practice & worked breakdowns

Worked Examples

Example 1 — Finding the first word: Which of these four words comes FIRST in alphabetical order: BUTTON, BUCKET, BUDGET, BURROW?

Answer: All four start 'BU', so compare the 3rd letter: BUT-, BUC-, BUD-, BUR-. C comes before D, R and T, so BUCKET is first.

Example 2 — Finding the last word: Which of these four words comes LAST in alphabetical order: ENGINE, ENOUGH, ENTIRE, ENVELOPE?

Answer: All four start 'EN', so compare the 3rd letter: ENG-, ENO-, ENT-, ENV-. V comes after G, O and T, so ENVELOPE is last.

Example 3 — Spotting the word out of place: These four words are almost in alphabetical order, but one is out of place: OBJECT, OBTAIN, OBSTACLE, OBVIOUS. Which word is out of place?

Answer: The correct order is OBJECT, OBSTACLE, OBTAIN, OBVIOUS (comparing the 3rd letter: J, S, T, V). In the given list OBSTACLE appears after OBTAIN instead of before it, so OBSTACLE is out of place.

Example 4 — Full ordering: Put these four words in full alphabetical order: QUIVER, QUIET, QUOTE, QUARREL.

Answer: All four start 'QU', so compare the 3rd letter: QUARREL (A), QUIET (I), QUIVER (I), QUOTE (O). QUARREL comes first (A). QUIET and QUIVER both have 'I' next, so compare the 4th letter: QUIE- vs QUIV- — E comes before V, so QUIET then QUIVER. QUOTE is last (O). Answer: QUARREL, QUIET, QUIVER, QUOTE.

Example 5 — Using the second letter when the first is tied: Which of these four words comes FIRST in alphabetical order: RIBBON, RIDDLE, RIPPLE, RITUAL?

Answer: All four start 'RI', so compare the 3rd letter: RIB-, RID-, RIP-, RIT-. B comes before D, P and T, so RIBBON is first.

Foundation

(15 questions)

1. Which of these four words comes FIRST in alphabetical order: BUTTON, BUCKET, BUDGET, BURROW?

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2. Which of these four words comes FIRST in alphabetical order: ENGINE, ENOUGH, ENTIRE, ENVELOPE?
3. Which of these four words comes FIRST in alphabetical order: OBJECT, OBTAIN, OBVIOUS, OBSTACLE?
4. Which of these four words comes FIRST in alphabetical order: QUIVER, QUIET, QUOTE, QUARREL?
5. Which of these four words comes FIRST in alphabetical order: RIBBON, RIDDLE, RIPPLE, RITUAL?
6. Which of these four words comes FIRST in alphabetical order: UNIQUE, UNIFORM, UNUSUAL, UNTIDY?
7. Which of these four words comes FIRST in alphabetical order: VOYAGE, VOLUME, VOWEL, VOUCHER?
8. Which of these four words comes FIRST in alphabetical order: WHISKER, WHISTLE, WHIMPER, WHIRLWIND?
9. Which of these four words comes FIRST in alphabetical order: EXPLORE, EXAMPLE, EXACT, EXCUSE?
10. Which of these four words comes FIRST in alphabetical order: YONDER, YIELD, YOLK, YEARN?
11. Which of these four words comes FIRST in alphabetical order: ZEALOUS, ZIGZAG, ZODIAC, ZESTY?
12. Which of these four words comes FIRST in alphabetical order: BRAVERY, BRACKET, BREEZE, BROTHER?
13. Which of these four words comes FIRST in alphabetical order: CUSHION, CURTAIN, CUSTOM, CURIOUS?
14. Which of these four words comes FIRST in alphabetical order: DAZZLE, DEBATE, DECENT, DEPUTY?
15. Which of these four words comes FIRST in alphabetical order: FESTIVE, FEATURE, FERTILE, FEEBLE?

Standard

(20 questions)

1. These four words are almost in alphabetical order, but one is out of place: BUCKET, BUDGET, BUTTON, BURROW. Which word is out of place?
2. These four words are almost in alphabetical order, but one is out of place: ENGINE, ENOUGH, ENVELOPE, ENTIRE. Which word is out of place?
3. These four words are almost in alphabetical order, but one is out of place: OBJECT, OBSTACLE, OBVIOUS, OBTAIN. Which word is out of place?
4. These four words are almost in alphabetical order, but one is out of place: QUARREL, QUIET, QUOTE, QUIVER. Which word is out of place?

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5. These four words are almost in alphabetical order, but one is out of place: RIBBON, RIDDLE, RITUAL, RIPPLE. Which word is out of place?
6. These four words are almost in alphabetical order, but one is out of place: UNIFORM, UNIQUE, UNUSUAL, UNTIDY. Which word is out of place?
7. These four words are almost in alphabetical order, but one is out of place: VOLUME, VOUCHER, VOYAGE, VOWEL. Which word is out of place?
8. These four words are almost in alphabetical order, but one is out of place: WHIMPER, WHIRLWIND, WHISTLE, WHISKER. Which word is out of place?
9. These four words are almost in alphabetical order, but one is out of place: EXACT, EXAMPLE, EXPLORE, EXCUSE. Which word is out of place?
10. These four words are almost in alphabetical order, but one is out of place: YEARN, YIELD, YONDER, YOLK. Which word is out of place?
11. These four words are almost in alphabetical order, but one is out of place: ZEALOUS, ZESTY, ZODIAC, ZIGZAG. Which word is out of place?
12. These four words are almost in alphabetical order, but one is out of place: BRACKET, BRAVERY, BROTHER, BREEZE. Which word is out of place?
13. These four words are almost in alphabetical order, but one is out of place: CURIOUS, CURTAIN, CUSTOM, CUSHION. Which word is out of place?
14. These four words are almost in alphabetical order, but one is out of place: DAZZLE, DEBATE, DEPUTY, DECENT. Which word is out of place?
15. These four words are almost in alphabetical order, but one is out of place: FEATURE, FEEBLE, FESTIVE, FERTILE. Which word is out of place?
16. These four words are almost in alphabetical order, but one is out of place: GENEROUS, GENTLE, GESTURE, GENUINE. Which word is out of place?
17. These four words are almost in alphabetical order, but one is out of place: HUMBLE, HUNGRY, HUSTLE, HURDLE. Which word is out of place?
18. These four words are almost in alphabetical order, but one is out of place: IMAGINE, IMMENSE, IMPULSE, IMPROVE. Which word is out of place?
19. These four words are almost in alphabetical order, but one is out of place: JOINT, JOSTLE, JOVIAL, JOURNAL. Which word is out of place?
20. These four words are almost in alphabetical order, but one is out of place: KINDLE, KINGDOM, KITCHEN, KINSHIP. Which word is out of place?

Hard

(5 questions)

1. Put these four words in full alphabetical order: GENUINE, GESTURE, GENEROUS, GENTLE.
2. Put these four words in full alphabetical order: HUMBLE, HUNGRY, HURDLE, HUSTLE.

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3. Put these four words in full alphabetical order: IMAGINE, IMPROVE, IMPULSE, IMMENSE.
4. Put these four words in full alphabetical order: JOURNAL, JOSTLE, JOVIAL, JOINT.
5. Put these four words in full alphabetical order: KINDLE, KINGDOM, KINSHIP, KITCHEN.

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